seemed that the pain was going to be too much. However, the plan did not work as well as I'd hoped and after the area was numbed I found I had no idea where my fingers were. I actually went back to the hotel, disappointed that even after having the excruciatingly painful injection the situation had not improved. In the end, though, I managed to play in the final, despite being in considerable pain. In the gap between the semi-final and the final I had also visited a doctor in Sri Lanka, who said he could get me ready for the final and that I would have to take the medicine he prescribed twice a day. However, as a side effect I would not be able to sleep properly for the first three days, but once the medicine had run its course I would sleep a lot. He was right. The medicine did help and I did eventually play in the final – but, as warned, I wasn't able to sleep for three nights and then slept for three days!

In the warm-up before the match, the umpires walked up to me to check that I was aware of what I was getting into: because I was carrying an injury suffered before the game started, I would not be allowed a substitute. But I had considered all the consequences and was ready to pull myself through the pain to try and win the coveted IPL trophy.

Twice in the match the ball hit my injured hand. The first time was when I was fielding at fine leg. On the second occasion I was standing at cover when Suresh Raina, the left-handed middle-order bat, played a full-blooded cover drive that came to me in a flash. I instinctively stopped the ball and realized soon afterwards that my stitches had burst. At the changeover my hand was bleeding. I ignored it and went out to bat wearing the special gloves, which had no gap between the middle and index fingers. Wearing these, I could at least get a grip on the bat, and I managed to make 48. Unfortunately for us, the IPL trophy continued to elude us as we lost too many wickets in a heap and fell 22 runs short of the target.

A lot was written about the decision to bat Kieron Pollard at number seven during the run chase in that 2010 final. It was a decision taken by the management based on my input and the reasoning was clear. As long as the spinners were bowling, we wanted the likes of Ambati Rayudu and Saurabh Tiwary, both of whom were good players of spin, to be out in the middle. Pollard could then come in and take on the faster bowlers. In hindsight, however, I believe that sending Pollard up the order would have been the better option. It was a mistake and I have no hesitation in admitting it.